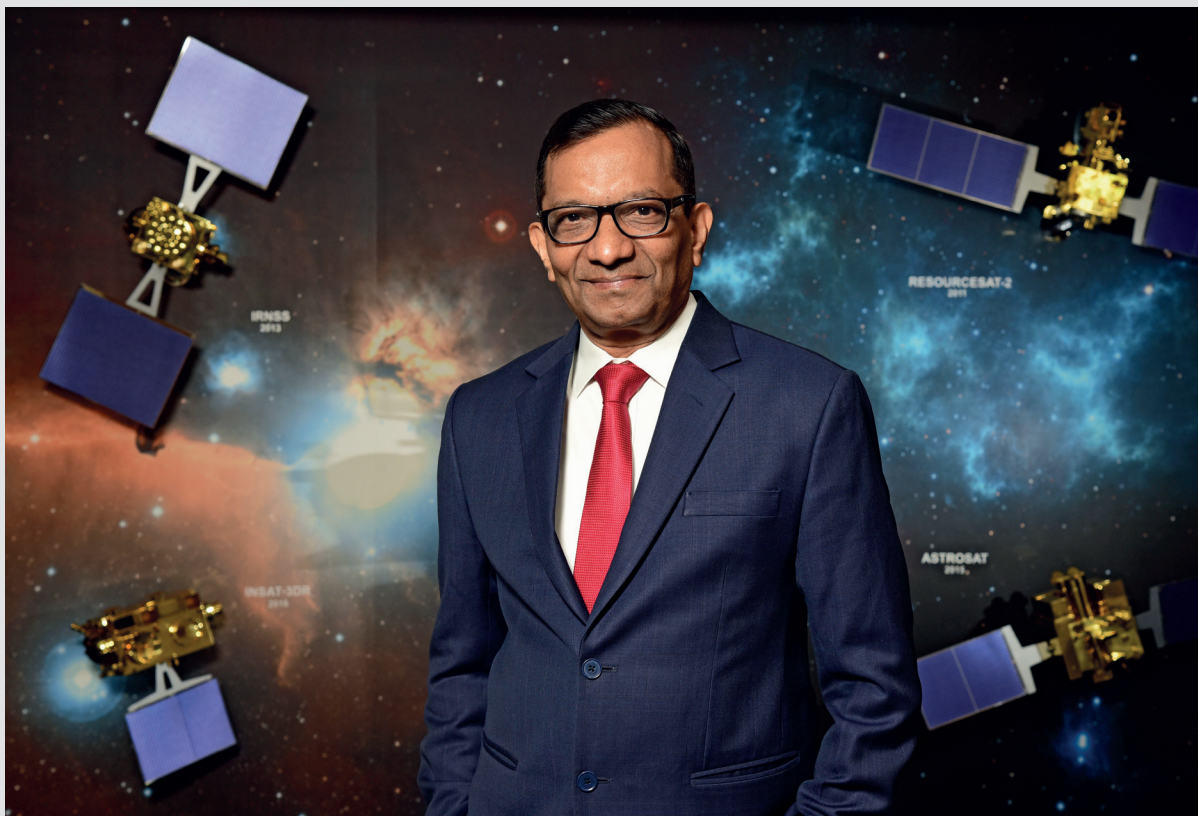




AIMING FOR THE STARS IN-SPACe Chairperson Pawan Goenka hopes that satellite manufacturing will become a large activity

With the new space policy in the final stages of approval, how soon can we expect it to be formalised?

It would be difficult for me to give you a timeline. What I can tell you is that the policy draft is being reviewed for final approval. However, most of what is there in the policy is already be-

ing applied. That's why Skyroot didn't have to wait for the policy to be released formally.

What's the update on attracting FDI into the segment?

We are revisiting the FDI policy as currently it is restrictive on the funding that can come into India, which often

leads to investments happening outside the country. We will revise the policy so that there are no unreasonable constraints both in terms of investments as well as setting up companies here.

How soon can we expect a spacetechnology unicorn?

This is not some kind of crystal-ball gazing, but I would personally be very happy if we have the first unicorn by 2023-end.

What is next on your agenda for 2023, as far as both upstream and downstream segments are concerned?

The primary objective for us now is to look for opportunities for companies to get in. The big items on our agenda would be applications and the manufacture of satellites. We would also like to explore how we can do more commercial launches from India for global players like the one we did for OneWeb with GSLV-Mk III. India has several things going for it including infrastructure, low cost of launches, technical expertise and, most importantly, the reliability of our rockets. **BT**

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‘IN-SPACE IS WORKING ON INCENTIVISING THE PRIVATE SECTOR TO WORK WITH ISRO IN THE AREA OF APPLICATIONS IN A BIG WAY’